Peter Bergen and Swati Pandey looked at the backgrounds of 79 terrorists involved in five of the worst anti-West terrorist attacks and found 'madrasah involvement to be rare and further noted that the masterminds of the attacks all had university degrees' (Fair, 2009). The pattern was the same in Pakistan. Sheikh Omar, who was involved in the murder of Daniel Pearl, graduated from the London School of Economics (LSE) and Naeem Noor Khan alias Abu Talha, Communication Manager of Al Qaeda, received an IT degree from Karachi University.[8]

The religious quarters in Pakistan asserted that the West was wary of political Islam, which it thought stemmed from the Qur'an, masjid and madrasah. Hence, madrasahs were being targeted. Moreover, many Pakistanis suspected that the US sought to de-Islamise Pakistan's educational system. Christine Fair met high-level officials in the US Department of State who confirmed that it was one of their goals (Fair, 2009).

The recruitment patterns of TTP and Al Qaeda in Pakistan showed that their recruits did not come from madrasahs. One cogent reason is that unlike Afghan Taliban, TTP leadership was not madrasah graduate; therefore, it was difficult for them to woo madrasah students. Maybe they did not want to entice them into their ranks because madrasah students would have been more qualified in Islamic teachings, making them look more suitable for the leadership of the so-called Islamist group. Therefore, they might have been considered a threat to their leadership. Probably, Al Qaeda also adopted a similar recruitment policy.

According to intelligence sources, among those who carried out suicide attacks in Pakistan, only a few were identified to be students of any madrasah. However, this aspect should not be considered less important as the madrasah students are most vulnerable to be influenced by prolonged militancy and extremism in Pakistan. Some research data indicated that madrasah students had a greater flair or zeal for jihad than the students in other educational streams. It further suggested that madrasah students were consistently more likely than students in private or public schools to support war with India and militants in Kashmir were less likely to support equal rights for minorities and women (Fair, 2009).

By means of their education, madrasah students could be conveniently rallied around the slogan and mission of *Amr Bil Maruf Wa Nahi Anil Munkar* (correction of the morals and values of society through words and actions) and challenge the writ of government,